

NAME OF SCHOOL: MATER MISERICORDIAE SECONDARY SCHOOL,
RUMOMASI

TERM: FIRST 2026/2027 ACADEMIC SESSION

WEEK: ONE

CLASS: SS3

SUBJECT: English Language

TOPIC: Lexis & Register

Introduction

- Lexis is the total vocabulary of a language; lexicology studies words, their meanings, structures and relationships. Register is the variety of language appropriate to a situation — formal, informal or technical.

Word formation

- Words are formed by **derivation** (adding affixes: happy → unhappy, happiness), **compounding** (two words: headmaster, notebook), **conversion** (change of class: to email, to Google), **blending** (brunch = breakfast + lunch), **clipping** (advertisement → advert), **acronyms and initialisms** (WAEC, NEPA), and borrowing from other languages (kola, yam from West Africa).

Register and its varieties

- Formal register** — standard, impersonal, passive and latinate vocabulary (official letters, speeches, essays).
- Informal register** — conversational, contractions, slang (texts to friends).
- Technical register** — the jargon of a discipline: 'acid, titration' in chemistry; 'defendant, appeal' in law; 'server, cache' in computing. Choosing the right register shows language competence.

Usage and misuse

- Distinguish similar words: affect/effect, principal/principle, stationary/stationery, complement/compliment, council/counsel. Avoid illiteracies like 'irregardless', double comparatives ('more better') and wrong collocations ('make a research' → 'carry out research').

CLASS EVALUATION

1. Define register.
2. Give one example each of formal, informal and technical register.
3. Form new words from 'write' using affixes.
4. Use 'complement' and 'compliment' in sentences.

**NAME OF SCHOOL: MATER MISERICORDIAE SECONDARY SCHOOL,
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TERM: FIRST 2026/2027 ACADEMIC SESSION

WEEK: TWO

CLASS: SS3

SUBJECT: English Language

TOPIC: Synonyms, Antonyms & Homonyms

Introduction

- Synonyms are words of similar meaning; antonyms are words of opposite meaning; homonyms are words that share spelling or pronunciation but differ in meaning.

Synonyms with shades of meaning

- Few words are exact synonyms — each carries a shade: big, large, huge, enormous differ in degree; shout, yell, scream differ in intensity and context; begin, commence, initiate differ in formality. Choose the precise word: 'The teacher reproved the pupil' (gently) vs 'reprimanded' (officially).

Antonyms

- Gradable (hot/cold, rich/poor), complementary (dead/alive, married/single) and relational (buy/sell, teacher/student). An antonym is usually formed with a prefix: honest → dishonest, legal → illegal, responsible → irresponsible, patient → impatient.

Homonyms, homophones and homographs

- **Homophones** — same sound, different spelling/meaning: right/write, their/there, site/sight, peace/piece, affect/effect.
- **Homographs** — same spelling, different sound/meaning: lead (metal / to guide), tear (eye drop / to rip), wind (air / to twist).
- **Homonyms** — same spelling and sound but different meanings: bank (river / money), bat (animal / sports tool), watch (timepiece / observe).

Context in use

- The meaning of a homonym is decided by context: 'The bank of the river was full of marsh grass.' Only context disambiguates such words.

CLASS EVALUATION

1. Define synonym, antonym and homonym.
2. Write the antonyms of: legal, patient, honest, happy.
3. Distinguish between homophones and homographs with two examples each.

4. Use 'bark' in two sentences showing two meanings.

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TERM: FIRST 2026/2027 ACADEMIC SESSION

WEEK: THREE

CLASS: SS3

SUBJECT: English Language

TOPIC: Emphatic Structures

Introduction

- Emphatic structures are grammatical devices used to place special stress on a part of a sentence — to highlight, correct or contrast information.

Devices of emphasis

- **It-cleft:** 'It was John who broke the cup.' (focus on John)
- **Wh-cleft/pseudo-cleft:** 'What I need is more time.' (focus on the complement)
- **Inversion:** 'Never have I seen such a sight.'; 'Rarely does he complain.'; 'Not only did she pass, she topped the class.'
- **Emphatic do/does/did:** 'I do love this school.'; 'He did apologise.'
- **Intensifiers and fronting:** 'This, I must say, is remarkable.'; 'Very/terribly/extremely good.'
- **Rhetorical repetition and contrast:** 'It was not the money, but the principle.'

Using emphasis in speech and writing

- In speech, stress and intonation carry emphasis ('JOHN broke the cup'). In writing, cleft and inversion structures are more formal and accurate than italics or capitals. Emphatic structures appear in comprehension ('what was emphasised?') and in continuous writing.

Common errors

- Avoid 'It is me who is...' confusion; ensure the verb agrees with the focused subject: 'It is the students who are late.' Maintain word order after inversion: 'Seldom have I seen...' (not 'Seldom I have seen...').

CLASS EVALUATION

1. Rewrite 'John stole the money' using an it-cleft focusing on John.
2. Transform 'I have never seen a better match' using inversion.
3. What does emphatic 'do' express? Give an example.
4. Why are cleft structures preferred in formal writing?

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TERM: FIRST 2026/2027 ACADEMIC SESSION

WEEK: FOUR

CLASS: SS3

SUBJECT: English Language

TOPIC: Expository Essays

Introduction

- An expository essay explains, informs or describes a topic objectively — it presents facts, defines concepts and clarifies ideas. Examples: 'The importance of education', 'How to prepare for WAEC', 'Types of pollution'.

Structure

- **Introduction** — a clear statement of the topic and the writer's approach (3–4 sentences, ending with the thesis).
- **Body** — 3–5 paragraphs, each with a topic sentence followed by explanations, examples, facts, statistics or definitions in a logical order (chronological, cause-effect, problem-solution, compare-contrast).
- **Conclusion** — a summary of the main points and a final thought; no new ideas.

Language of exposition

- Third person; formal, impersonal tone ('It is generally agreed...'); present tense for general truths; precise vocabulary; linking words of addition (furthermore), contrast (however), cause (therefore) and sequence (firstly, next); objective, not emotional, language.

Planning and pitfalls

- Plan before writing: list points, group related ones, order them, write, check. Pitfalls: straying from the topic, weak topic sentences, unsupported claims, informal language, and a conclusion that introduces new matter. Keep within the word limit; write neat, legible work.

CLASS EVALUATION

1. Write the introductory paragraph of an exposition on 'The importance of reading'.
2. What is a topic sentence?
3. List three effective linkers for expository writing.
4. State two pitfalls to avoid in an expository essay.

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TERM: FIRST 2026/2027 ACADEMIC SESSION

WEEK: FIVE

CLASS: SS3

SUBJECT: English Language

TOPIC: Argumentative Essays

Introduction

- An argumentative essay presents a reasoned case for or against a proposition ('Boarding school is better than day school'). Its aim is to persuade, using evidence, logic and rhetoric, not emotion alone.

Plan

- **Introduction** — state the proposition and your stand clearly.
- **Body** — 3–5 supporting arguments, each in its own paragraph with a topic sentence, explanation, example/evidence, and relevance to the proposition.
- **Counter-argument and refutation** — acknowledge the other side and show why it is weaker ('Admittedly... however...').
- **Conclusion** — restate the stand with force and a call to action.

Language of argument

- Formal and persuasive; modal verbs of certainty (must, ought, surely); concessive linkers (although, even though, admittedly); causal links (because, consequently, therefore); rhetorical questions; statistics and expert opinion; parallel structures and balanced sentences. Never use slang or personal attack.

CLASS EVALUATION

1. Outline an argument IN FAVOUR of 'Mobile phones should be banned in schools' in four paragraphs.
2. What is a counter-argument and why must it be answered?
3. Give two persuasive devices used in argumentative writing.
4. State the purpose of the conclusion.

**NAME OF SCHOOL: MATER MISERICORDIAE SECONDARY SCHOOL,
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TERM: FIRST 2026/2027 ACADEMIC SESSION

WEEK: SIX

CLASS: SS3

SUBJECT: English Language

TOPIC: Comprehension & Summary: Exam Technique

Introduction

- In WAEC/NECO, comprehension and summary questions test understanding, precision and economy of language. Good technique is as important as good English.

Comprehension skills

- Read the passage twice — first for the gist, then with the questions in mind. Answer in your own words unless asked to quote; full sentences; one idea per answer; match marks with points; note tone (the writer's attitude: sarcastic, admiring, critical) and the devices of persuasion.

Summary technique

- Identify the key points that answer the question; express each in one clause; paraphrase (never lift whole sentences); sequence the points as they appear; count the words and keep to the limit; if a figure is given ('in one sentence, state two reasons') obey it exactly.

Common penalties

- Copying chunks of the passage; exceeding the word limit; answering two questions in one; omitting points; wrong tense agreement; missing the instruction (e.g. 'state four' but giving three).

Practice passage plan

- Read, underline key sentences, ask 'what is the writer saying about...?', draft the summary in your own words, edit for economy, check the instruction was followed, then write cleanly with a word count at the end.

CLASS EVALUATION

1. Why should you read a comprehension passage twice?
2. State three rules of summarising.
3. What is tone in a passage?
4. Why is copying from the passage penalised in summary questions?